

HEMANT CHAWLA



PRANAB MUKHERJEE
EXTERNAL AFFAIRS MINISTER
JANGIPUR, WEST BENGAL

RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

422 512

First time Lok Sabha MP, the five-term Rajya Sabha member will have to battle the Left hard to make things happen.

RAVI'S SAHANI



SHARAD PAWAR
AGRICULTURE & FOOD MINISTER
BARAMATI, MAHARASHTRA

RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

107 51

Using power and politics, Pawar has converted the drought-prone region into a model seat which is the envy of many.

SIPRA DAS



P. CHIDAMBARAM
FINANCE MINISTER
SIVAGANGA, TAMIL NADU

RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

124 196

In his sixth term, Chidambaram has tried to pump prime the constituency with investments and development projects.

BANDEEP SINGH



KAMAL NATH
COMMERCE MINISTER
CHINDWARA, MADHYA PRADESH

RANK

Socio-economy Infrastructure

383 327

Has nursed it well to be elected seven times. But lack of investments and its location in a BIMARU state show up badly.

ALL 20 constituencies in Kerala are in the top 100 list.

79 OF THE TOP 100 constituencies are located south of the Vindhyas.

thanks to the dividend of legacy the commercial city delivers. The real shocker is that Bihar boasts of 32 of the worst 100 constituencies while Uttar Pradesh is home to 29 to the bottom of the pile. Curiously the listing reads virtually like the first list of 100 worst districts classified by the Patel Committee in 1964. It is as if time has stood still.

Go south to discover another India. Nearly 80 per cent or 79 of the 100 best constituencies are located south of the Vindhyas. Indeed, Palakkad, the worst performing constituency of Kerala, is ranked 94 on the billboard chart. Very simply all the 20 Kerala constituencies are in the top 100 list. You could say it is the Kerala model which has made this happen, and could credit E.M.S. Namboodiripad for his vision. If that is so, whom do you blame for the woes of its communist cousin West Bengal which has only one—the imperial capital Kolkata—in the top 100. Nothing reveals the sloth in the system that renders even the most voluble politician ineffective better than this study.

Yes, the rankings do reflect in a great

measure the progress made by a state where the Lok Sabha seat is located. MPs from Punjab—which has been ranked the best state by INDIA TODAY'S The State of The States six years in a row—and Kerala which has topped governance, education and health for many years, do derive the benefits. As do the MPs who represent major metros like Mumbai, Chennai, Delhi or Kolkata, who have inherited developed constituencies thanks to the British Raj and the natural advantage of being commercial and political capitals.

It is not a story only of legacy or a reflection of the state's performance though. The rankings depict the harsh truth that efficacy of governance at the local level matters most. In 1998, the NDA came to power riding on the 179 seats won by the BJP. In 1999, after Pokhran II, after having lost the trust vote by one vote, after the victory in Kargil, the BJP won 181 seats. You could say it was a wave, yet 82 of its MPs, who formed the cache of 179, were not re-elected. It is not just BJP which faces this. Every general election sees